REDISCOVERING THE COPPER PLATE CIRCUIT: A JOURNEY THROUGH SOUTHERN INDIA'S RICH HISTORY AND NATURAL BEAUTY





The Raviz Group of Hotels has embarked on an ambitious endeavor to revive an ancient tourist route that once connected the southern regions of Kerala with Tamil Nadu. This historical route, which thrived during the 1970s and 80s, served as a bustling trading path between Tamil Nadu and Kollam, a major port in Kerala. The revitalized route has been aptly named 'The Copper Plate Circuit' in homage to Kerala's oldest copper plate document, the 'Tharisappalli Sasanam.' This ancient decree, issued by King Ayyanadikal Thiruvadikal, granted land and privileges to Syrian Christians, providing tangible evidence of pre-European Christianity in Kerala.

The Copper Plate Circuit seamlessly links Kanyakumari, Thiruchendur, Srivilliputhur, Thenkasi, and Madurai to the southern regions of Kerala, offering a diverse range of experiences that span centuries and cultures.

The journey begins in Kanyakumari, where India's southern tip meets the Bay of Bengal, featuring a stunning skyline adorned with ancient temple towers and fragrant breezes of jasmine. Madurai, once the capital of the Pandya Kingdom, welcomes travelers with historical treasures, including the iconic Meenakshi Amman Temple and Tirumalai Nayak Palace.

As the circuit unfolds, Courtallam captivates with thundering waterfalls and ancient temples, while Srivilliputhur showcases Dravidian architecture and divine abodes of Lord Vishnu. The Thiruchendur Murugan Temple, perched on the Bay of Bengal's shores, invites visitors to immerse themselves in the region's s piritual heritage.

Tenkasi, often referred to as the "Kasi of the South," is home to the magnificent Kasiviswanathar Temple and a network of waterfalls, including the renowned Courtallam Falls. Shendurney, nestled in the Western Ghats, beckons with its rich botanical diversity, featuring numerous endemic species and the elusive lion-tailed macaque.

The journey leads to Kollam, where travelers can relax by the serene waters of Lake Ashtamudi, exploring the beauty of Monroe Island and the nearby Jatayu Earth Center. **The Leela Ashtamudi,** A Raviz Hotel, offers an ideal getaway in this destination, allowing guests to embark on idyllic houseboat cruises.

Heading south, Kovalam welcomes visitors to India's only cliff-top beach resort, **The Leela Kovalam**, A Raviz Hotel, where dreams of a perfect vacation come to life. Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala's capital, boasts the Padmanabhaswamy Temple, renowned for its opulent treasures.

The circuit also provides opportunities to explore other historical remnants, such as Anjengo Fort, constructed between the 17th and 18th centuries.

As travelers embark on The Copper Plate Circuit, they are destined to be enchanted by the beauty, history, and culture of this once-forgotten trade route, reaffirming the timeless wisdom that sometimes, "choosing the path less traveled makes all the difference."



